

Netflix open sources the FlameScope CPU tool

To solve latency problems in a microservice, Netflix has open sourced the FlameScope tool. This tool is being released publicly and new features are being added to make it more widely applicable to other use cases. The new visualisation tool instantly generates flame graphs from sections of system profiles.

Netflix has a long history of releasing utilities developed internally for debugging and performance analysis as open source software. The tool is expected to be a hit amongst programmers and operators aiming to identify the origin of performance issues. Netflix's FlameScope is a performance visualisation utility helpful to programmers and systems administrators. It will allow them to analyse CPU activity by generating a sub-second-offset heat map, in which users can select arbitrary spans of time for further analysis by selecting a portion of the heat map, for which a flame graph is generated for the corresponding block of time.

As per the blog post by Netflix, this tool, in particular, automates the task of selecting ranges in a CPU profile for visualisation in flame graphs, which was the very purpose of creating it.

As this is the initial release, additional features are in the process of being developed, and will be added in the future. The authors are actively soliciting outside contributors to implement features and new ideas, to make the utility more general-purpose. The project is written in Python and JavaScript/Node.js. Presently, FlameScope only handles data from perf on Linux, though support for other profile sources is planned, the post noted. Additional interactive features, such as palette selection and data transformation, as well as the ability to export the resulting flame graph as an SVG, are also priorities.

Recently, Microsoft made plans to work along with CA Technologies, Cisco, HPE, SAP and SUSE. Together, these firms will provide more predictability for users of open source software. The move is the latest from Microsoft in its campaign to become a leading open source ecosystem member.

Announcing the new licence-compliance partners, Red Hat sources informed, "The large ecosystems of projects using the GPLv2 and LGPLv2.x licences will benefit from the adoption of this more balanced approach to termination derived from GPLv3."

Endgame launches open source initiative

Endgame has released a set of open source tools that allow enterprises to test defences against modern attacker behaviour. These are called Red Team

ENDGAME.

Automation (RTA) tools.

Security teams that lack sufficient time and resources will now have the ability to measure protection capabilities beyond malware-based attacks. This is because RTA tools directly map to MITRE's ATT&CK matrix, the most comprehensive framework for attacker techniques and tactics.

Only 49 per cent of today's cyber attacks represent a major vulnerability concern for organisations facing fileless or malwareless-based attacks that bypass existing security controls. Testing an organisation's ability to stop such behaviour is often too complex. The MITRE Corporation has supposedly developed the best model of modern attacker capabilities. With Endgame's RTA, customers will now have access to a turnkey validation toolkit that helps teams better understand their security posture.

"Endgame's RTA is simple and easy to implement or extend, allowing practitioners to effectively test their organisations' defences against techniques outlined in the ATT&CK framework. With RTA, enterprises will have a better assurance that their protections can withstand even the most sophisticated attacker behaviour. We are pleased to make this free and open source contribution, and look forward to working with the community on its improvement," said Mark Dufresne, director of threat research and adversary prevention, Endgame.

Endgame plans to release additional scripts in the coming months that expand this coverage across the entire ATT&CK matrix, and is also accepting pull requests from the industry to contribute to its open source project.

Endgame has shared the RTA framework publicly to help organisations accelerate and enable the assessment process and highlight detection coverage and gaps. As a result, organisations will be able to focus more confidently on monitoring real-time detection in their enterprise and fill the critical gaps in coverage.

Developer-focused Oracle Code event held in Bengaluru

With 2018 touted to be a defining year for modern cloud developers, Oracle hosted its global, flagship 'Oracle Code' developer focused event series in India. At this second edition of Oracle Code Bengaluru, developers were treated to a range of keynote addresses, technical sessions and hands-on labs delivered by industry luminaries, community members and Oracle experts.

Oracle sees Indian developers increasingly preferring open, container native technologies for rapid application development and deployment. As developers understand the need to move fast, build for the cloud, but retain the flexibility to run where the business or workloads require, there is a greater inclination towards open source based, community driven technology stacks to avoid cloud lock-in.